

Monkeys and Trunks

Fiction

In the beginning, when the Earth was young and incomplete, there was a problem with different parts connecting. The problem was that the land didn't connect with the sea, the sky didn't connect with the land and the trees didn't connect to the ground.

The sea was filled with fish who were as happy as could be. But the crabs were sad because they were stuck on the ocean floor. So, they asked the Creator politely to help them. The Creator took pity on the crabs and, because they had asked so nicely, they were given legs to exercise and the ability to breathe in the air. Then the Creator connected the land to the sea to make beaches and the crabs happily marched onto the land.

The sky was filled with birds who were as happy as could be, riding the winds with their wings. But when the wind didn't want to help them, the birds had to flap their wings hard just to stay in the air. So, they asked the Creator politely to help them. The Creator took pity on the poor, tired birds and, because they had asked so nicely, they were given claws to grip. Then the Creator connected the sky to the trees so that the birds could rest on the high branches.

The trees were filled with monkeys who were as happy as could be, eating the fruit and the leaves. But then they noticed that some of the ripe, juicy fruit fell to the ground where they couldn't reach it. So, they wailed to the Creator, "Oi! Give us back our fruit."

The Creator was so angry that the monkeys were so rude and so decided not to help them. Instead, the Creator sent lots of other animals to eat the fruit that the monkeys couldn't reach. One day, an elephant noticed that there was fruit in the trees as well as on the ground. He reached up his long, grey trunk and started to pluck the tasty treats. On seeing this, one of the monkeys had an idea.

She quickly grabbed the greedy elephant's trunk and tied it to the branch. Then she slid down his long, wrinkly nose, scurried along his back and swung off his tail. As quick as a wink, she picked up some of the fallen fruit and threw it up to the other monkeys in the branches.

When they had finished eating, she grabbed a juicy mango and climbed all the way up the elephant until she was safely back up in the branches.

"Thank you," she chuckled, "you have been most helpful." Then, she untied his trunk and pushed the mango into the end of his nose as a token of her gratitude.

On seeing this, the Creator laughed loudly and decided to connect the trees to the land below.

From that day onwards, in memory of the cheeky monkeys and the greedy elephants, this part of the tree became known as the 'tree trunk'.